

Finding Friends (找朋友)

GOAL

The game use **two decks** of 52 cards with red and black jokers. Five players form two teams with partnerships changing from round to round. Each player uses a *level* to track their score throughout the game ; they win when having moved up from 2 to Ace levels (Ace level must be won, it cannot be skipped).

Each round, the **defenders team** is trying to prevent the **challengers team** from capturing 80 card points or more in tricks : "**Kings**" (10pts), "**Tens**" (10pts) and "**Fives**" (5pts).

Card points in the talon are captured by the last trick winner and **multiplied by twice the number of cards led to the last trick**.

Total of card points captured by the challengers	Round result
0 points	The defenders move up three levels
5 to 35 points	The defenders move up two levels
40 to 75 points	The defenders move up one level
80 to 115 points	Draw
120 to 155 points	The challengers move up one level
160 to 195 points	The challengers move up two levels
200 points or more	The challengers move up three levels (<i>above 235 points, move up one extra level per increment of 40 points</i>)

ROUND SETUP

Each round, the deck is shuffled and the previous **leader** draws first, then in counter-clockwise order, each other player draws a card until everyone have 20 cards in hand (8 cards are left remaining). During this draw phase, players can bid for setting the trump suit and becoming the round leader.

At any time during the draw, a player may nominate a trump suit by exposing (*) **a single or an identical pair of cards of their own level rank**. A single card can be **overridden by another player exposing an identical pair of their own level rank**.

A player cannot override themselves with a different suit, however they may **reinforce** their single card by exposing the **second** identical card later (providing no pair was exposed in the meantime).

A pair can only be overridden by a **pair of jokers of the same color (black or red)**, which sets a short-trump suit.

Trump nomination phase :

 6	 J  J	Joker, Joker
B. (level 6) exposes clubs	D. (level J) decides to nominate hearts by exposing a pair	As 6 of clubs was overridden, B. is allowed to nominate another suit and decide to expose two black jokers

(* Exposed cards are taken back in hand before the first trick. A new round is played if no trump has been nominated at the end of the draw phase)

The player who sets the trump suit becomes the *leader* and must:

- Take the 8 remaining cards in hand and discard an equal number to form a new talon, without revealing it to other players.
- Call a partner by announcing a *non-trump* card and an *ordinal* (e.g. : «first ♥A played», «second ♠A played», ...). The leader and partner become the *defenders team*, other players are playing collectively as the *challengers team*. Teams become public when the announced card is played to the trick (it's possible for the leader to play all by himself if playing the announced card).
- Lead the first trick.

TRUMP SUIT

The *leader's* level is the **trump rank** of the current round.

The trump suit is, from high to low : *red joker, black joker, trump rank card of the trump suit, other trump rank cards, the remaining cards of the trump suit*

Example with six as trump rank and clubs as trump: **red joker, black joker, ♣6, [♠6/♦6/♥6 - all equal], ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q, ♣J, ♣10, ♣9, ♣8, ♣7, ♣5, ♣4, ♣3, ♣2**

Within other non-trump suits, the cards descend from Ace to 2, excluding the trump rank.

If a short-trump suit is set, from high to low : *red joker, black joker, all trump rank cards.*
Example with six as trump rank: **red joker, black joker, [♣6/♠6/♦6/♥6 - all equal]**

TRICK PLAY

The leader starts by playing one or several cards from their hand. In counter-clockwise order, all players have to follow suit unless they are void of that suit, in which case they may play any card(s). **When a challenger wins a trick, card points are captured and set aside face-up (defenders card points are not tracked).** The winner leads a new combination.

Different **combinations** can lead a trick :

- single
- pair (♣3♣3) (*pair of equal trump rank must also share the same symbol*)
- at least two consecutive pairs (♥Q♥Q, ♥J♥J) (*Whether pairs are consecutive depends on the trump rank, ♠6♠6, ♠4♠4 are consecutive if 5 is the current trump rank*)
- multiple trick (*see § after*)

If other players can follow the led suit, they are **obligated to match the combination type to the fullest extent possible** :

- if able to fully match the combination within the led suit, they **must play those cards**
- if not able to fully match the combination, they **must match a looser variant** in the same suit

For example, if a trick is led with two consecutive pairs (♣8♣8, ♣7♣7), the ordering of required following plays is: two consecutive pairs in the same suit (♣4♣4, ♣3♣3) > Any two pairs in the same suit (♣K♣K, ♣6♣6) > One pair in the same suit and two other cards in the same suit (♣8♣8, ♣6, ♣5) > Any four cards in the same suit

Trick example :

♣J ♣J	♣10 ♣10	♥10, ♠5	♣7, ♣5	♣A, ♠6
A. leads a pair (and ultimately wins the trick)	B. is forced to play their only pair in clubs	C. (partner) has no more clubs	D. has no pair in clubs	E. plays their last clubs and another suit

There's no match requirement when following a trick in a different suit, but **in order to trump, a player must match the combination type** (a pair of trumps to defeat a pair, two consecutive pairs of trumps to defeat two consecutive pairs). If the same card is played by two players, the first one played has precedence.

MULTIPLE TRICK

Several single cards of the same suit can be led simultaneously if the player is **certain** (*) that these cards are the **highest ones** remaining in that suit. Other players must play the same amount of cards as were led, as far as possible they must play cards of the suit led. Having run out of cards of the suit led, a player may play any cards he chooses. A multiple trick can only be defeated by playing an **equal amount of trump cards**.

♣A was previously played, **♥** is trump :

♣A, ♣K	♣10, ♣3	♣10, ♠5	♣5, ♠2	♥K, ♥3
A. leads cards that are the highest remaining in clubs	B. only has two clubs, and is forced to play a 10	C. (partner) has no more clubs	D. plays their last clubs	E. is void in clubs and trumps every cards to win the trick

Different combinations of the same suit can also be led simultaneously if the player is **certain** that these combinations are the **highest of their type** remaining in that suit. A multiple trick can be evident (**♣A, ♣K♣K** or **♣A♣A, ♣K**), or determined from previous plays (**♣A, ♣5 ♣5, ♣2 ♣2**, if no players matched a pair of clubs in a previous trick). In order to beat a multiple trick, **each of its combination must be individually trumped** (**).

♥K was previously played, **♣** is trump:

♥A ♥A, ♥Q ♥Q	♥10 ♥10, ♥3 ♥3	♥8 ♥8, ♥3, ♠5	♥7 ♥7, ♥6 ♥6	♣5 ♣5, ♣2 ♣2
A. leads two pairs	B. has only two pairs of hearts,	C. (partner) plays his last hearts	D. has only two pairs of hearts,	E. trumps with two pairs

(* A multiple trick can be determined through card counting and observation of players' void suits. Once a multiple trick has been led, each player should in counter-clockwise order confirm that all cards led cannot **possibly** be defeated within the same suit. For example, **♣A, ♣K** is not valid if the second **♣A** is still in another player's hand. **♣A ♣A, ♣Q ♣Q** is not valid if no **♣K** has been played by other players. If a multiple trick is invalid, combination(s) that can possibly be defeated are still led, but other cards are taken back in hand. As a penalty, for each card that has to be withdrawn, 10 card points are transferred from the team that led incorrectly to the other team. If an error is not discovered until later, the offending team automatically lose the round.)

(** If several players trumped a multiple trick, the tie-breaker is the highest play of the largest combination. Trick order precedence applies if still tied.)

REFERENCES

Version 1.0 (02-18-2026)

This document uses edited material from <https://www.pagat.com/kt5/pengyou.htm>,
<https://benzhang.io/tractor> , <https://robertying.com/shengji/rules.html> ,
<https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/2990582/consolidated-rules>